

03 Lists, Links and Media

Ordered and unordered lists · Anchor tag and paths · Images, video, audio and iframes

Lists

```
<ul>                <ol start="3" reversed>    <dl>
  <li>HTML</li>        <li>Step</li>            <dt>HTML</dt>
  <li>CSS</li>        </ol>                <dd>A markup language</dd>
</ul>                </dl>
```

- Use `<ul>` when the order does not matter and `<ol>` when the sequence is meaningful, such as steps or rankings.
- The **only valid direct child** of `<ul>` and `<ol>` is `<li>`. A nested list must be placed *inside* an `<li>`, never between two of them.
- `<dl>` is a description list built from terms (`<dt>`) and their descriptions (`<dd>`). It suits glossaries, FAQs and specification sheets.
- Useful `<ol>` attributes: `type="A|a|I|i|1"`, `start` and `reversed`.
- The standard markup for a navigation menu is `<nav>` > `<ul>` > `<li>` > `<a>`.

Links

```
<a href="about.html">Relative link</a>
<a href="https://site.com" target="_blank" rel="noopener noreferrer">New tab</a>
<a href="#pricing">Jump to a section on the same page</a>
<a href="mailto:me@site.com">Email</a>   <a href="tel:+919999999999">Call</a>
<a href="resume.pdf" download>Download CV</a>
```

Path	Meaning
page.html	A file in the same folder.
./images/a.png	Inside the images folder of the current folder.
../index.html	One folder above the current one.
/about.html	From the site root, immediately after the domain.

WHY REL="NOOPENER NOREFERRER" ACCOMPANIES TARGET="_BLANK"

Without it, the newly opened page can reach back through `window.opener` and redirect the original tab to a malicious address, an attack known as tabnabbing. Modern browsers apply this protection by default, but writing it explicitly is still standard practice.

Images

```


<figure>
  
  <figcaption>Signups grew by 40 per cent in the second quarter</figcaption>
</figure>
```

- The **alt attribute is mandatory**. Screen readers announce it, it is displayed when the image fails to load, and search engines index the image through it.
- If an image is purely **decorative**, write an empty `alt=""` so that assistive technology skips it. Removing the attribute altogether is incorrect, because the file name may then be read out instead.
- Supplying `width` and `height` lets the browser reserve space in advance, which prevents **cumulative layout shift**.
- `loading="lazy"` defers loading until the user scrolls near the image. It should not be applied to a hero image that appears above the fold.
- `srcset` and `<picture>` serve different image sizes or modern formats such as WebP with a fallback.

Audio, video and iframes

```
<video controls poster="thumb.jpg" width="640">
  <source src="clip.webm" type="video/webm">
  <source src="clip.mp4" type="video/mp4">
  Your browser does not support the video element.
</video>

<iframe src="https://www.youtube.com/embed/xyz" title="Lecture video"
width="560" height="315" allowfullscreen></iframe>
```

- Without the `controls` attribute no player interface is shown, and playback must then be driven through JavaScript.
- When several `<source>` elements are supplied, the browser picks the **first format it supports** and ignores the rest.
- Text placed between the opening and closing tags is **fallback content**, displayed only when the element itself is unsupported.
- `autoplay` works only when the video is also `muted`, since browsers block unmuted automatic playback.
- An `<iframe>` should always carry a `title`, as screen reader users depend on it to understand the embedded frame.

QUICK RECAP

- List type communicates whether order matters; nested lists live inside `<li>`.
- Relative paths are resolved from the current file, absolute paths from the site root.
- Every image needs an `alt`, and dimensions on images prevent layout shift.